ACCELERATING INDIA'S SHIFT TO WASTEWATER REUSE AND RESOURCE RECOVERY

India's growth is placing increasing pressure on its most essential resources—water and waste systems that operate largely out of sight yet determine how cities sustain themselves.



SANDEEP ASOLKAR
Chairman and Managing Director of SFC Environmental Technologies Ltd.

For Sandeep Asolkar, Chairman and Managing Director of SFC Environmental Technologies Ltd., this challenge has been addressed not through scale alone, but through engineering discipline and technology-led systems that enable infrastructure to perform reliably over time.

When he founded his company in 2004, wastewater treatment was largely viewed through the lens of regulatory compliance. His approach was to treat it as a systems problem—one that required consistency, automation, and adaptability to real-world conditions.

This thinking led to the development and adoption of C-Tech, a Sequential Batch Reactor (SBR)-based wastewater treatment technology. Over two decades, C-Tech has remained a market leader in India's SBR segment, commanding approximately 80% market share. The platform's sustained relevance reflects a focus on process stability, operational efficiency, and long-term performance—attributes that continue to define its widespread adoption.

Yet, as water availability becomes an increasingly structural concern, the sector is undergoing a shift—from treatment for compliance to treatment for reuse. Recognizing this early, Asolkar has steered the company toward building technology platforms that enable this transition.

Today, SFC's portfolio spans the full spectrum of wastewater treatment and reuse systems. Alongside biological treatment through C-Tech, the company integrates advanced tertiary and polishing technologies—including submerged ultrafiltration (SUF), membrane bioreactors (MBR), reverse osmosis systems, and emerging solutions such as MABR—to support consistent, reuse-ready water quality across industrial and urban applications. The focus remains clear: enabling customers to treat and reuse wastewater with confidence, efficiency, and operational simplicity.

In parallel, he led SFC's diversification into solid waste management through Hindustan Waste Treatment Pvt. Ltd., extending the company's environmental engineering capabilities beyond water. The business addresses municipal solid waste through integrated systems such as bio methanation and resource recovery—reflecting a broader approach to environmental infrastructure at a time when waste management is becoming an equally pressing challenge for growing cities.

As national programs continue to expand and regulatory expectations evolve, the need for reliable, standardized, and reuse-ready systems is becoming more pronounced. The opportunity is no longer limited to creating capacity, but to ensuring that infrastructure delivers consistently over decades.

For Asolkar, the perspective remains grounded:

"The objective is not just to treat wastewater, but to enable its reuse in a manner that is cost effective, dependable and sustainable."

In a sector where impact is measured over long horizons, his work reflects a steady approach—combining technical depth with strategic clarity, and building systems that quietly support the foundations of India's growth.